

Baari

The Ken Case Competition 2026 · Opening 07, "What to cook today?" · Product Build track

Aaj kya banega? Pehle ye batao, aaj kiski baari hai.

01 Who is this team, and why is this opening yours?

One line per member · 50 words as a team

Vinay built voice and payments infrastructure and has shipped on Gnani since his internship. Chaitanya has instructed a part-time cook daily for three years and interns in product and design. Keshav runs the same loop in his own kitchen. We have already interviewed eleven households in five states.

48 words

02 The one customer insight you discovered

60 words · proof optional, and scored

Eleven households told us the same thing. Whoever cooks asks what to make, the family says "anything," she cooks it, and someone orders out anyway. The decision never sticks because nobody actually agreed to it. One mother eats "anything random" while her children eat delivery, then throws the rest out the next day. So Baari gets agreement before she cooks.

60 words

Attach in this order: the Pune recording, timestamped where she calls the kitchen chaos almost everyday; a fridge or shelf photo; the Figma boards; the working session logs.

03 How your agent works, in six steps

Six cells · one sentence each · 15 words max

1. At 9pm it offers the two dishes the cook says she can make tomorrow. (14)
2. It knows every veto, health rule, headcount, what is home, and whose turn it is. (15)
3. Everyone gets sixty seconds to agree or object, then tomorrow is settled. (12)
4. It calls her in Hindi, confirms portions aloud, and pays inside household caps. (13)
5. It asks the duty-holder once, only for a swap or overspend. (11)
6. Done when the dabba comes back and every plate is logged. (11)

04 How your solution touches each rail

Payments · logistics · voice · one sentence each

Payments. Pine Labs P3P with Grantex holds one household food wallet on UPI ReservePay, so the cook can buy what is missing under her own capped and named permission instead of paying cash and waiting to be reimbursed at the end of the month.

Logistics. Quick commerce covers the daily top-up, clubbed into a single cart across the houses one cook serves in the same building, and Delhivery carries only the monthly staples run, because a decision taken at 9pm for an 8am kitchen needs ten-minute fulfilment.

Voice. Gnani runs the 7:45am Hindi and Hinglish call with DTMF fallback on whitelisted numbers, and we do not authenticate anyone by voice, because a call can only tell you which handset answered, not who spoke into it.

05 Which rail will you innovate on?

Select one · 40 words

Pine Labs. UPI lets one person make many payments. It cannot let one payment have several people behind it, or one person act for several households. Our cook buys for four families and can be a delegate of none.

39 words

06 Which customer asset will you ask for?

30 words

One family WhatsApp group, cook included. No other place holds both. More context comes at days fourteen and thirty, never upfront, so trust is built before it is spent.

29 words

07 The annexation: which use case do you subsume next?

30 words

Hiring and paying domestic help. A marketplace sells a rating because nobody watched the kitchen. Our loop logs four hundred meals per cook, her timings, and what she learned.

29 words

08 Which of the sixteen openings would you never hand to an assistant?

One opening · one sentence

Running your wedding, because what is really being measured is whether the people who love the couple spent their attention on it, and an assistant doing it perfectly is exactly what would ruin that.

09 Which Indian company should have built this already?

One company · 60 words

Reliance Jio. It has just announced CallAgent, an AI inside the network that joins calls in twenty-two languages for five hundred million users and can order food. It already owns JioMart, JioFinance and the cook's phone line. It has not built this because Jio counts SIMs rather than households, and JioMart is measured on order volume, which this reduces.

59 words

10 Which track are you entering?

Select one · locks with your submission

Product Build.

Before this goes in

- Confirm eleven households is a number the team can produce if asked. It appears in two answers and is the easiest claim to validate.
- Confirm the three years on Chaitanya's cook. If it is closer to eighteen months or four years, use the true figure.
- Confirm consent is on record for the Pune recording. Quotes get published with age band and city, never a name.

For the rails round: walk in with the reproducible ACTIVE_SBMD_EXISTS failure and the UPI Circle one-primary-per-delegate rule blocking a four-home cook. Those turn answer 05 from an ask into a demonstration.